CALVARY EXOTICS

CARE SHEET

Crested Gecko Care Guide

Everything you need to set up and care for a crested gecko, from the breeder's bench in Tyler, TX: enclosure, temperature, humidity, feeding, handling, and what to watch for.



SCIENTIFIC NAME **Correlophus ciliatus**	ORIGIN **New Caledonia; nocturnal, arboreal**	ADULT SIZE **About 8 in with tail; 35–55 g**	LIFESPAN **15–20 years**
TEMPERATURE **70–80°F (never above 80°F)**	HUMIDITY **Mist every other day, let it dry between**	DIET **Prepared crested gecko diet, every other day**	LIGHTING **Day/night cycle; low UVB optional**

Enclosure

- **Tall and vertical.** Height matters more than floor space.
- **Juveniles:** 12×12×18 in. **Adults:** 18×18×36 in or larger.
- Plastic or glass with some ventilation. Never full-screen (all mesh); it cannot hold humidity.
- Climbing and hiding space at several heights: cork bark, branches, vines, and plenty of foliage.
- Feeding ledge or dish up off the floor.

Substrate & Bioactive

- Paper towel for hatchlings and new arrivals; coconut fiber or a bioactive mix for an established gecko.
- Bioactive uses live plants plus a cleanup crew of springtails and small isopods.
- **Skip large isopods.** A gecko can swallow bedding while hunting them, risking impaction.
- Avoid sand, gravel, and fine loose substrate for hatchlings. Never use cedar or pine.

Temperature & Lighting

- Room temperature is usually right: **70–80°F**. Overheating is the bigger risk.
- Most Texas homes need no heat lamp. Keep away from sunny windows, vents, and warm electronics.
- 10–12 hours of light, then full dark. A timer helps.
- UVB is optional. If used, low level (2–5%) with plenty of shade and foliage.

Humidity & Water

- Wet-then-dry cycle. Mist until leaves and walls have droplets, then let it dry out.
- **Plastic with small vents:** mist every other day.
- **Glass with open screen top:** mist twice every other day.
- Use dechlorinated or filtered water. Offer a clean shallow water dish too.
- Soaked or musty enclosure? Mist less.

Feeding

- Staple: a complete prepared crested gecko diet mixed with water to a thin, ketchup-like paste.
- All ages: fresh food **every other day**. Remove leftovers after about 24 hours.
- Insects are optional but help growth: weekly for babies and juveniles, about monthly for adults. Dust with calcium with D3.
- Fruit is not needed. Too much sugar is not good for them.
- Weigh on a gram scale now and then to catch weight loss early.

Handling

- Give a new gecko 1–2 weeks to settle. Make sure it is eating and drinking first.
- Short sessions of 5–10 minutes in the evening. Keep low, over a bed or sofa, since they jump.
- Let it walk hand to hand. **Never grab or pull the tail.** A dropped tail does not grow back.
- Skip handling during shedding or if it seems stressed.

Signs to Watch For

- Stuck shed on toes or tail tip: raise humidity; see a vet if it does not clear.
- Sunken, wrinkled eyes or skin: dehydration.
- Weight loss or refusing food for more than a couple of weeks.
- Bent jaw or limbs, kinked spine or tail, tremors: possible metabolic bone disease.
- Bubbles at the nose, wheezing, open-mouth breathing: possible respiratory infection.

NOTE General information, not veterinary advice. If unsure, contact an exotic vet. Quarantine any new animal away from your others.

Shopping Checklist

- ☐ Tall enclosure (18×18×36 in; smaller for juveniles)
- ☐ Substrate, cork bark, branches, foliage
- ☐ Crested gecko diet and feeding dish
- ☐ Thermometer, hygrometer, mister, light timer
- ☐ Gram scale; optional low-output UVB

Scan for the full guide, FAQ and morph info

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